

nicknamed Schwammerl (literally “little mushroom”) because of his diminutive chubby figure, Schubert was soon established as a minor celebrity in the tight-knit world of Viennese musical enthusiasts. His wide group of literary and artistic friends celebrated his gifts through private gatherings dubbed Schubertiades, at which selections of his music were performed. Schubert attracted the attention and admiration of a famous singer of an older generation, Johann Vogl (1768–1840), whose performances introduced his songs to a wider public.

Schubert’s extravagant life put some strains on his finances, but these were largely alleviated by the well-paid summers he spent at the rural estate of the Hungarian aristocrat Count Esterházy, giving lessons in singing and piano to the count’s two daughters. Much of the music Schubert wrote during this period, such as the famous “Trout” Quintet of 1819, breathes happiness and tranquillity.



THE RED CRAB